FLAN



YIELD	ACTIVE TIME	REST	OVEN
8 servings	**15 min**	**4 h chill, or overnight**	**350F, 40-45 min in a water bath**

ENERGY COST
$2.58 (45 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)

INGREDIENTS

4 large	Eggs
2 large	Egg yolks
1/2 tsp	Kosher salt
1 can, 14 oz	Sweetened condensed milk
1 can, 12 oz	Evaporated milk
	Vanilla paste: 1 tsp, or half a vanilla bean, or 1 tbsp extract
1 cup	Granulated sugar, for the caramel
1/4 cup	Water, for the caramel
a pinch	Kosher salt, for the caramel

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F and set up a water bath. A 9 inch cake pan inside a roasting pan works.
2. Blend the eggs, yolks, salt, both milks and the vanilla about 30 seconds, until smooth. Do not aerate it. If it froths, let it settle.
3. Caramel: dissolve the sugar in the water over medium-low heat.
4. Turn the heat to high and boil about 5 minutes, until it goes from clear to light gold. The boiling is what drives the water off.
5. As soon as it turns light gold, drop to medium-low and take it to a proper golden brown.
6. Pour into the pan at once and swirl to coat the base. It sets fast, so move quickly, and the pan will be very hot.
7. Let the caramel harden about 5 minutes.
8. Stir the custard, pour it over the set caramel, and cover tightly with foil.
9. Sit it in the water bath and fill with hot water from a kettle.
10. Bake 40 to 45 minutes, until just jiggly but set.
11. Cool 30 minutes on the counter, then chill at least 4 hours or overnight.
12. Run a knife round the edge, invert onto a plate, smack the base to release.

NOTES

Blend rather than whisk, but stop at smooth. Bubbles blended in become holes in the set custard.
The 5 minute hard boil on the caramel is deliberate: it removes water so the caramel sets instead of staying syrupy.
Two cans plus 6 eggs total is a dense, firm flan rather than a loose one.
The chill is not optional. It will not unmould cleanly warm.